

Product Requirements Document (PRD)

Product Name

DevConnect

Product Vision

A professional networking platform designed specifically for developers to showcase skills, build meaningful connections, discover collaborators, and engage with technical content.

1. Problem Statement

Developers currently use multiple platforms for different needs:

- LinkedIn for networking
- GitHub for projects
- Discord/Slack for communities
- Hackathon platforms for collaboration

This fragmentation makes it difficult for developers to discover relevant peers, showcase technical expertise, and find collaborators based on actual skills and mutual professional interests.

DevConnect aims to provide a focused developer-centric networking platform that combines professional profiles, networking, content sharing, and intelligent developer recommendations.

2. Target Users

Primary Users

Student Developers

- College students
- Fresh graduates
- Placement-focused developers
- Hackathon participants

Early Career Developers

- Software engineers with 0–5 years experience
- Freelancers

- Open-source contributors
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Secondary Users

Technical Recruiters

- Looking for developers with specific skills

Community Builders

- Organizing projects, hackathons, and developer communities
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3. User Goals

Users should be able to:

- Create a professional developer profile
 - Showcase technical skills and projects
 - Connect with other developers
 - Discover developers with similar interests
 - Share technical updates and achievements
 - Communicate with their connections
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4. MVP Scope

4.1 Authentication

User Registration

- Email + password signup

Login

- Email + password login

Session Management

- JWT authentication

Logout

- Secure logout

4.2 Developer Profiles

Profile Creation

Users can maintain:

- Full name
- Headline
- Bio
- Skills
- Profile image

Project Showcase

Users can add:

- Project title
- Description
- GitHub repository link
- Live demo link

4.3 Developer Networking

Search Developers

Search by:

- Name
- Skill

Connection Requests

Users can:

- Send request
- Accept request
- Reject request

Connections List

View:

- Connected users
- Pending requests

4.4 Content Feed

Create Posts

Users can publish:

- Text posts
- Image posts

Feed

Show posts from:

- User
- Connected developers

Engagement

Users can:

- Like posts
 - Comment on posts
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4.5 Developer Recommendations

People You May Know

Recommendations based on:

- Mutual connections
- Shared skills

Each recommendation should display:

- Name
 - Headline
 - Shared skills count
 - Mutual connections count
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4.6 Real-Time Messaging

Direct Messaging

Connected users can:

- Send messages
- Receive messages instantly

Chat History

Persist messages in database.

5. Core User Flows

Flow 1: New User Onboarding

Register → Login → Complete Profile → Add Skills → Add Projects → View Dashboard

Flow 2: Networking

Search Developer → Open Profile → Send Connection Request → Request Accepted → Become Connected

Flow 3: Content Engagement

Login → Create Post → Post Appears In Feed → Other User Likes/Comments

Flow 4: Recommendation Discovery

Login → Dashboard → View Recommendations → Send Connection Request

Flow 5: Messaging

Connection Established → Open Chat → Send Message → Receive Real-Time Response

6. Edge Cases

Authentication

- Duplicate email registration
 - Invalid credentials
 - Expired JWT token
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Connections

- User sends request to self
 - Duplicate requests
 - Request already accepted
 - Request already rejected
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Profiles

- Empty skill list
 - Missing profile image
 - Duplicate skills
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Posts

- Empty post submission
 - Deleted post with comments
 - Multiple likes by same user
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Messaging

- User messaging non-connection
 - Offline recipient
 - Duplicate message delivery
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Recommendations

- User has no connections
- User has no skills
- No recommendation candidates available

7. Non-Goals (V1)

The following are intentionally excluded:

- Video calling
- Group chats
- AI-generated recommendations
- Job portal
- Resume builder
- Endorsements
- Skill assessments
- Public APIs
- Mobile application
- Multi-language support
- Advanced analytics
- Communities/groups
- Project collaboration marketplace
- Trending hashtags

These may be considered after product validation.

8. Success Metrics

User Acquisition

- Total registered users
 - Weekly active users
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Profile Completion

- % users with completed profiles
 - Average skills added per user
 - Average projects added per user
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Networking

- Connection requests sent
 - Connection acceptance rate
 - Average connections per user
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Engagement

- Posts created per week
 - Likes per post
 - Comments per post
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Messaging

- Messages sent per day
 - Active conversations
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Recommendation Quality

- Recommendation click rate
 - Recommendation-to-connection conversion rate
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9. MVP Release Criteria

The MVP is considered successful when:

- Users can register and login
- Users can create and update profiles
- Users can add projects and skills
- Users can connect with other developers
- Users can create posts
- Users can like and comment on posts
- Users receive meaningful recommendations
- Connected users can exchange messages
- System remains stable under normal usage